From Beginner to Intermediate

Relaxed movement, secure reading and a shared pulse.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

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1. A calm starting point

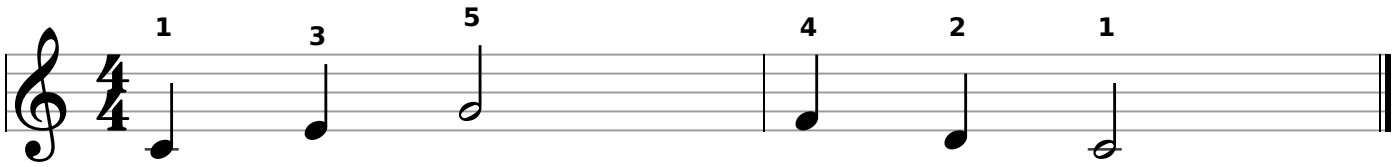
Check reading, counting and relaxed coordination.

A calm starting point

Before adding difficulty, play a short passage with each hand. Find the key and time signature, say the starting notes, and count one empty bar. Your wrist should move with the hand rather than hold it rigidly in place. If the bass reading or counting feels unfamiliar, revisit the matching Beginner chapter; the intermediate section stays available.

Practise · Right-hand check

Read before playing. Keep each quarter even.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand check

Use the bass staff. Say the beat while the note is held.

Listen and check

Could you locate the notes without a lit key? Repeat the harder hand at half speed. Continue when the passage feels comfortable, not merely when the app turns green.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Moving without stretching

Use the arm to carry the hand to its next position.

Moving without stretching

A position is a temporary starting place, not a shape you must keep stretched. Play a five-note group, release unnecessary pressure, and let the forearm carry the hand sideways to the next group. Keep the thumb near the keys and use its side. Stop if a movement hurts; smaller relaxed movements are the aim.

Practise · Two neighbourhoods

Play C to G, release, then move the whole hand to G position.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand travel

Look at the destination before moving. Keep the shoulders quiet.

Listen and check

Did the arm travel with the hand, or did the fingers reach while the wrist stayed behind? Practise the move silently twice, then repeat with sound.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. Different lengths in each hand

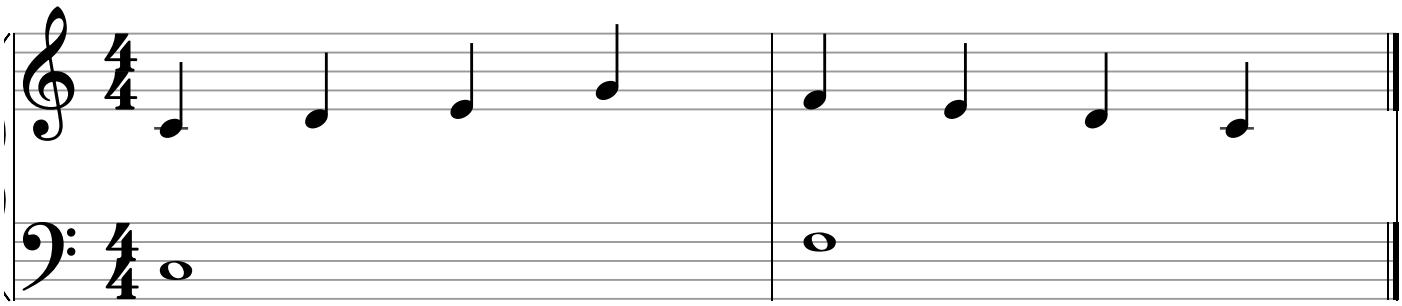
Let the melody move while the bass stays held.

Different lengths in each hand

Both hands share one pulse, but they do not always change together. Count four beats while holding a bass note; the right hand can play four separate notes above it. Release only the fingers whose notes have ended. First tap the two rhythms on your knees so finding pitches does not distract you.

Practise · One bass, four melody notes

Hold the left C through four right-hand notes.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Change on beat three

The left hand changes halfway through the bar. Count aloud.

Listen and check

Listen for an accidental gap in the long bass notes. The app can hear the starts, but you must check that the held hand stays down.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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4. Reading one group ahead

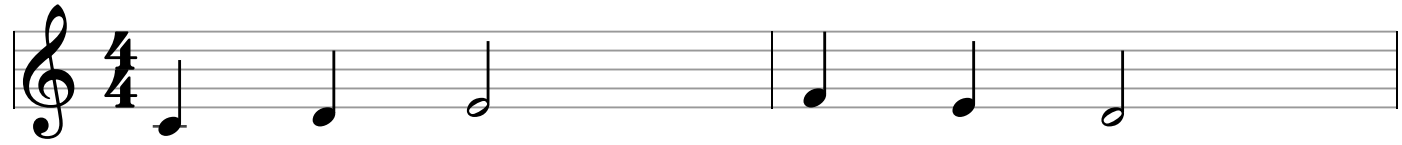
Prepare the next pattern while playing the current one.

Reading one group ahead

Read in small groups. Before starting, find the first note of each bar and notice repeated shapes. While holding a half note, glance at the next group. Do not try to read a whole page ahead. Use an easy tempo so your eyes can move without your hands racing.

Practise · Look during the half note

Use each half note as a chance to preview the next group.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Bass preview

Name the next bass note before the current note ends.

Listen and check

Describe the next bar before you play it. If you rely on the highlighted key, use Show me once, then repeat without it.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Keep the musical sentence moving
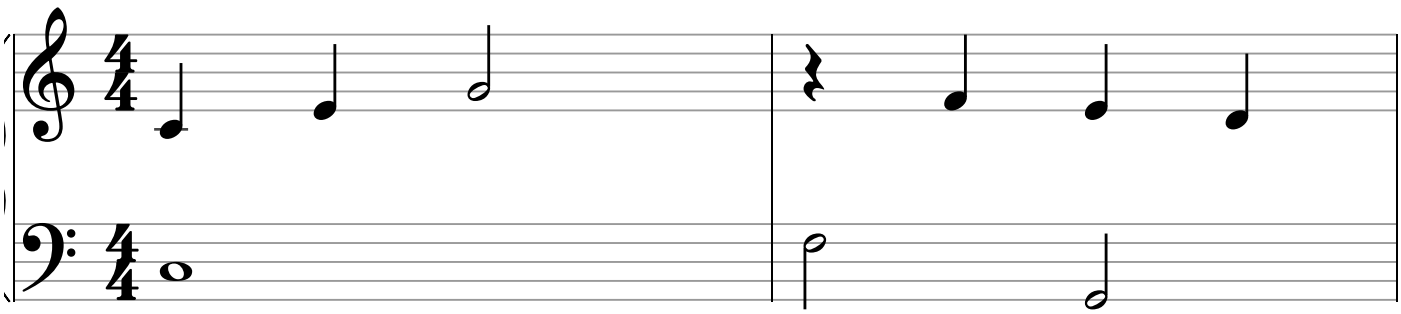
Recover without restarting the whole piece.

Keep the musical sentence moving

In careful practice, stop to repair a mistake. In a performance run, keep the pulse and join at the next secure note. These are different useful habits. Choose a slow tempo, mark two restart points, and count through a planned silent bar. Missing a note need not erase the beat.

Practise · Count through silence

Keep counting through the rest; do not shorten the empty beat.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A fresh starting point

Start confidently from this second phrase instead of returning to the beginning.

Listen and check

Try Flow at a comfortable speed for one continuous run. Then return to ordinary practice and loop the bar that caused hesitation.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

6. Jesus Loves Me: coordinated hands

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

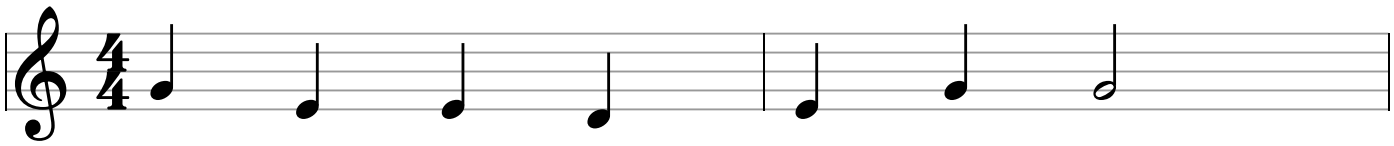
What to listen for

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Practise · Jesus Loves Me: coordinated hands

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Your musical check

Can you sing the tune and hear a continuous bass beneath it?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

7. The Doxology: a shared pulse

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

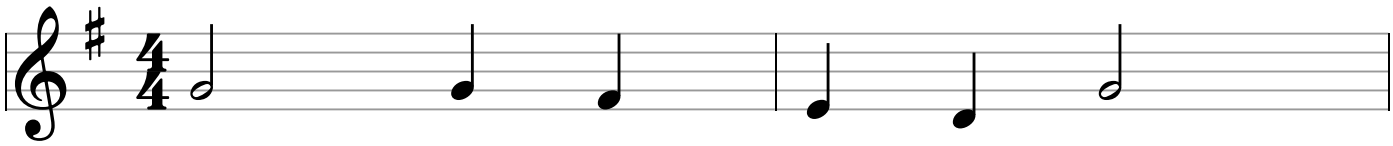
What to listen for

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Practise · The Doxology: a shared pulse

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Your musical check

Count through the final Amen and release both hands together.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. Amazing Grace

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.
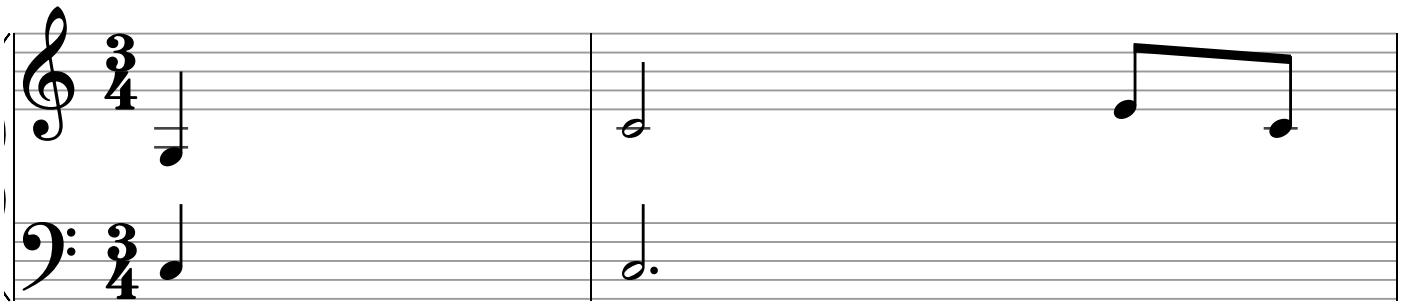
Prepare your recital

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Amazing Grace

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.



Opening example · 3/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Check reading, counting and relaxed coordination.
- ☐ Use the arm to carry the hand to its next position.
- ☐ Let the melody move while the bass stays held.
- ☐ Prepare the next pattern while playing the current one.
- ☐ Recover without restarting the whole piece.
- ☐ Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?
